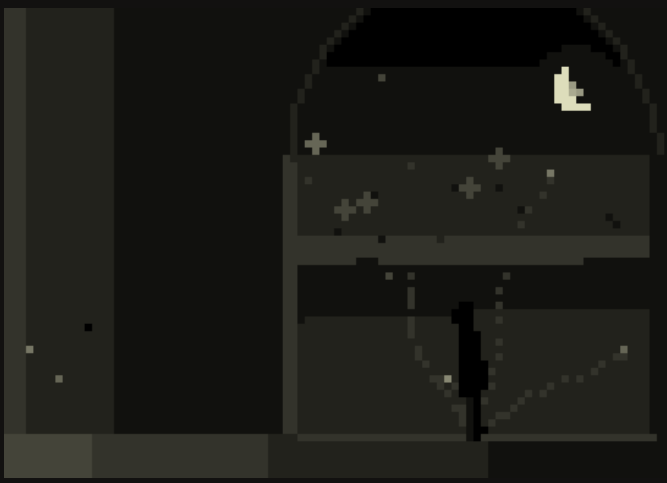


A N A M N E S I

a journey through memories, real and imagined

un luogo moderatamente sicuro

a script for monome norns

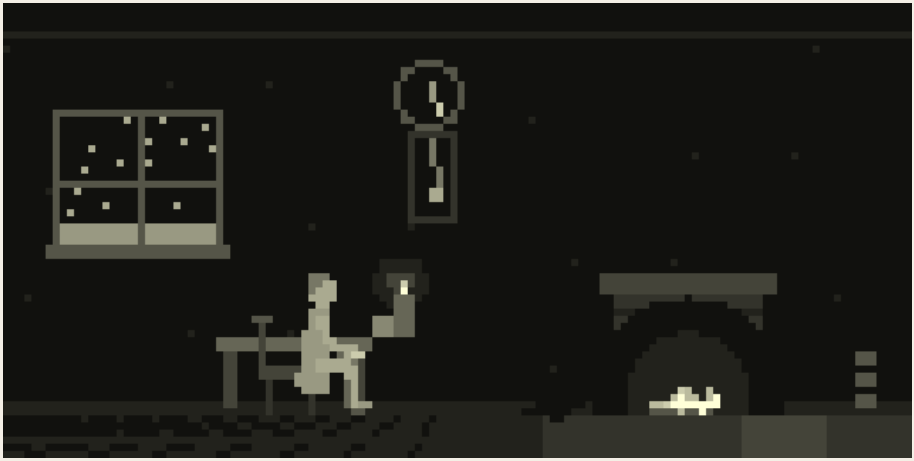
The world

Anamnesi is a journey into memories: the real ones and the imagined ones.

It begins at night, on a road, before a house with one lit window. Then a door opens, and you stand on the threshold: the fire behind you, every path ahead. Above lies the quiet. Below, everything else.

Each place is a small living world. Someone lives there: sits, gets up, looks out of the window, talks softly to someone who is gone. And each place has its own music, never quite the same twice: a theme runs through all of it, and resurfaces where you least expect it.

You can walk, or you can stay. Staying is a way of going: some paths only open to those who linger long enough. You can also let it wander on its own, in the background, and look up now and then.

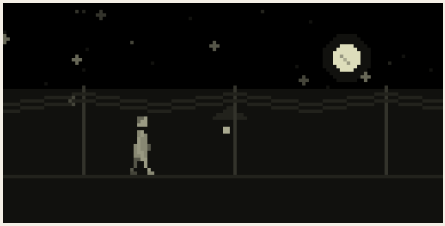


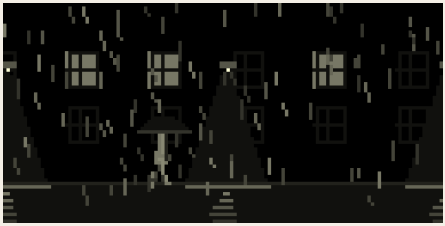
The journeys

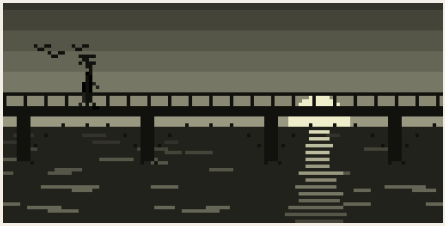
Between one place and the next there is no loading screen: there is a short film. First a black title card, with the chapter number and the name of the place you are heading to. Then an episode of two shots, with him in it: a wide shot and a close-up.

A road at night with telegraph poles and a passing car. Streetlights in the rain. A bridge at sunset. Stairs climbing towards the light and stairs going down into the dark. A bicycle among the poplars, the night bus, the train seen from inside and outside, snow, the sea, a lantern, a lit window with the grandparents at the table. The episode chooses itself, according to the direction, the layer and the time of day of the place you are reaching, and it never repeats straight away.

Meanwhile the music builds a bridge: the strings hold a chord and the piano hints at the theme, softly. If you are in a hurry, K3 during the journey skips to the end of the episode.





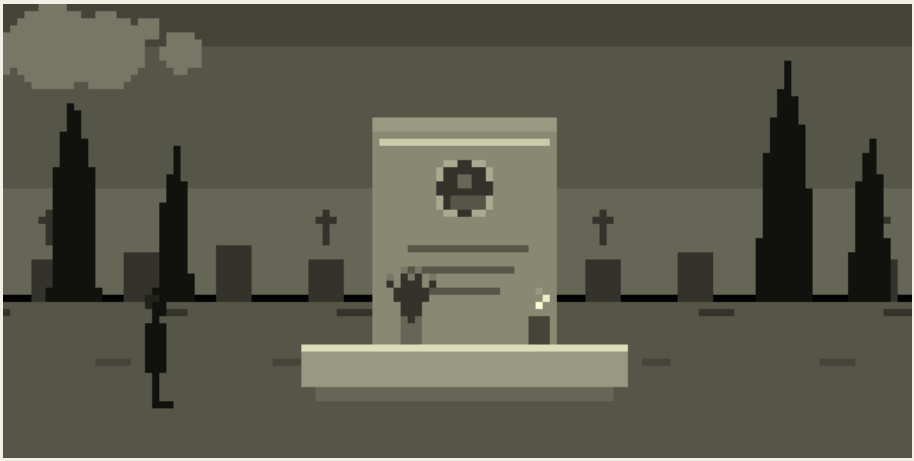




How to walk

K2	choose a path: up, down, left, right, and the hidden ones
K3	walk towards the chosen path (during a journey: skip the episode)
E1 E2 E3	the place's three macros: each place has its own
K1 + K2	evoke: the strings rise, the theme returns, the place says another sentence and starts again with new chords
K1 + K3	now / back then: the scene becomes an old photograph with its date, time slows, he becomes a child again; the music turns to worn tape and music box
K1 + E1	volume
K1 + E2	scroll through the paths
K1 + E3	space: more or less reverb

Nothing changes abruptly, but everything can be heard: every knob and key glides sound and light over two or three seconds. The K1 combinations work in every place, and during journeys too.



The macros

Each place assigns three macros to the three knobs. A macro moves many things at once: the sound, the voices that play and, often, what you see (the rain in the rain, the wind in the trees, the dark of night). When you arrive somewhere, the knobs take that place's values. The macro's name appears at the top right while you turn.

strings	a string orchestra slowly enters
heartbeat	the heart becomes audible, and quickens
warm / cold	from cold and glassy to warm and round
bells	the bells ring more often
choir	a choir holding the chords
far / near	everything moves near or far
echo	a tape echo that repeats and recedes
leaves	rustling leaves, wind in the branches
people	people around, voices, glasses
fragility	the memory wears out: tape, dust, forgotten notes
fire	the fire grows, the sound warms
childhood	a music box doubles the melody, the tape yellows
tears	slow strings, more space, held breath
light / shadow	the musical mode rises to light or sinks to shadow
sea	the waves, louder and closer
fog	everything veils over and fades into space
neurosis	shards, heartbeat, wavering pitch
night	crickets, owls, dark, fewer notes
rain	the rain, and the falling drops
depth	the low end opens, melodies sink
radio	a distant radio, through the static
breath / suspended	from suspended and sparse to full and flowing
memory	the theme returns more often, with echo
silence	voices withdraw, space remains
stars	celesta sparkles, rising light
faster / slower	faster or slower
train	a train passing, far away
wind	the wind rises, and moves things
voices	voices and whispers all around

The seven layers

From top to bottom: peace at the summit, the abyss at the bottom. With K2 you choose a direction: up leads towards quiet, down towards the night of the mind. Left and right keep you on the same layer.

THE SKY

The sea of stars · Under the stars · Happiness · Birth · Above the clouds · The garden · The rose of light · The silence of thoughts · The lullaby · The top floor · The northern lights · Rebirth · Peace · The other side

THE HEIGHTS

The mountain path · The meeting · Walking in the woods · Accepting · The mountain lake · The waterfall · The summit · The observatory · Atop the bell tower · The city rooftops · The walls of Amelia · The tower of memories · The mountain hut · The upside-down city · The cabin

CHILDHOOD

By the sea · The river · The night of falling stars · The smells of long ago · Country road · Grandpa's hand · The grape harvest · Summer at the grandparents' · June · Fireflies · The room you'd forgotten · The hayloft · The courtyard · Being ill · The village fair · Grandpa's vegetable patch · The classroom · The arcade · The olive mill · The little red car · The first memory · The carpeted room · Waking · The hollow in the woods

THE VILLAGE

The night train · The empty station · The distant city · Sunday in the village · After the party · The outskirts · The church at night · The old town · The summer square · The centre of everything · Fornole at sunset · The roads in the fog · New Year's Eve · The threshold · The lit windows · The playground · Snow on the village · The crossroads · The phone booth · The library of names · The shop at night · The monumental cemetery · The projection room · The cemetery at night · The funeral chapel · The abandoned town · Visiting Massimo · The film studio · The studio · The abandoned set

THE HOUSES

Rain on the roof · The abandoned house · Day after day · The orphanage · She reads · The dormitory · The wait · Your son · The refectory · The photographs · The washroom · The attic · The box room · Under the stairs · The infirmary · Grandfather between rooms · The visiting room · The old bed · The orphanage stairs · Before sleep · The room of the one who's gone · The day of the funeral · The empty house · The lady under the veil · The book for her · The voice you can't recall · The vigil · The mother you never saw · The hospital at night · The last breath · Twenty-five years later

THE MIND

Voices in the head · Unrequited love · A broken family · Judgement · Being someone's pain · Fear of the dark · Doubt · The deconsecrated chapel · The mirror · Renouncing · The nightmare · The asylum · Three in the morning · Locked in, screaming · The faces you can't remember · The missed chances · The life you never had · Running away · Forgetting oneself · Anger · No one talking · The cold floor

THE ABYSS

The marsh · The crypts · The river of forgetting · The abandoned asylum · The closed factory · The abandoned hospital · The closed subway · The silent shop floor · The well · The drowned world · The drowned village · The open sea · Those down there · Crying · The deep wood · The void · Pain · Before being born

And then there are the places that aren't on the map. They open only if you stay long enough in the right spot. One of them never ends.

The music

Each place has its own tonic, mode, progression and a group of voices that come and go by themselves. Beneath it all is a breath: four voices gliding from chord to chord over many seconds.

Twenty-four instruments, all synthesised live: felt piano, electric piano, celesta, music box, guitar, choir, a humming voice, strings, harmonium, organ, accordion, flute, bells, singing bowls, arcade square waves, an old radio.

Thirty soundscapes: rain, wind, sea, fire, crickets, cicadas, swallows, cowbells, a train, a typewriter, a singing photocopier. They switch on only when needed, so the norns can breathe.

Each place has an arc of a few minutes: it opens, reaches its peak, empties out into silence. At the peak the strings come in, and sometimes the choir. If you stay and listen, you never hear the same round twice.

In the houses, the mind and the abyss a low string line descends step by step, like a lament. The piano is felted: every note begins with a soft thud, and sometimes leaves a small echo an octave above.

The melodies breathe like a voice: they swell towards the middle of the phrase and fade at the end, arrive a little late, often close with an appoggiatura, a note that falls like a sigh. Chords sometimes enter with a suspended fourth and resolve later. When the theme returns, the strings rise softly beneath it.

Parameters

lingua / language	Italian or English (also chosen at start-up)
macro 1, 2, 3	the three knobs, MIDI-mappable
ora / allora	now or back then
parole / words	how often the sentences appear: often, sometimes, never
carattere / font	pixel, crisp without accents; soft, with accents
vagare / wander	after a few untouched minutes, it sets off again by itself
inizio / start	begin from the threshold or the last place
prologo	always, only the first time, never

Installation

From maiden:

```
;install https://github.com/unluogomoderatamentesicuro/anamnesi
```

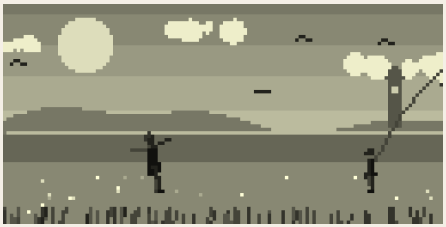
On first launch you need SYSTEM > RESTART, because the audio engine is new. The engine uses only standard SuperCollider components.

At start-up choose the language with E2 and confirm with K3. Any key skips the prologue.

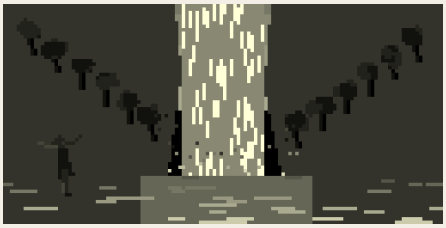
Some places



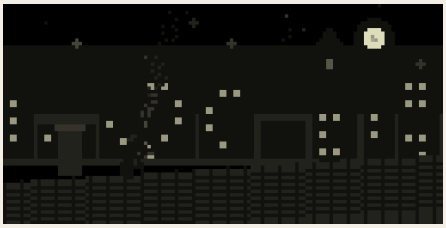
Under the stars



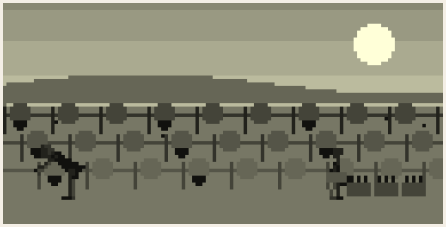
Happiness



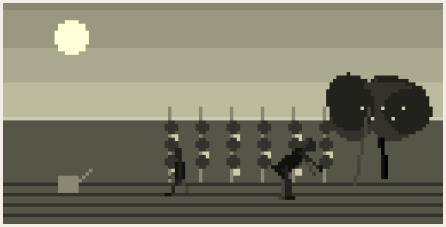
The waterfall



The city rooftops



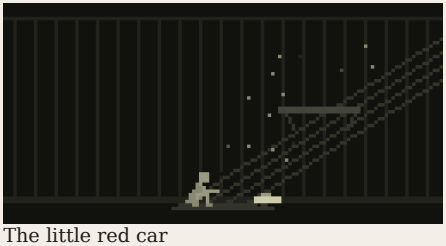
The grape harvest



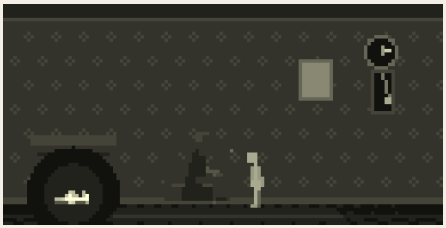
Grandpa's vegetable patch



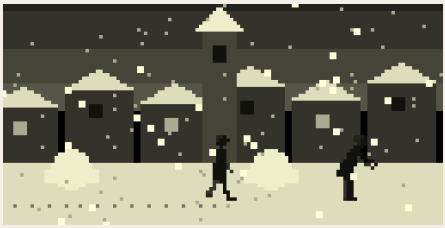
The smells of long ago



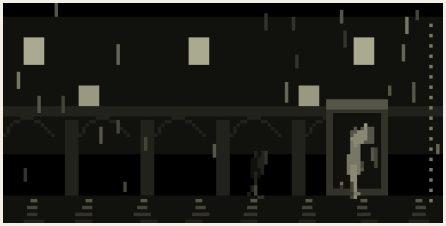
The little red car



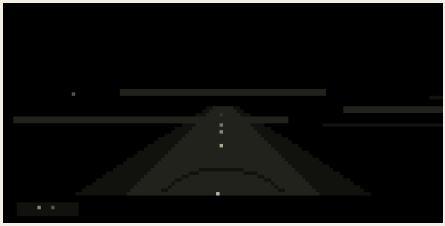
Grandpa's hand



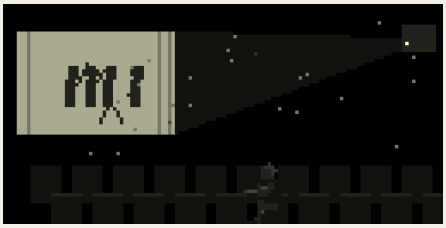
Snow on the village



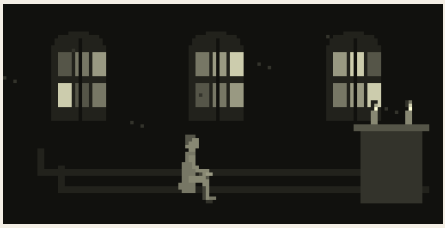
The old town



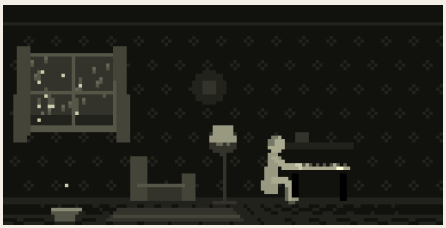
The roads in the fog



The projection room



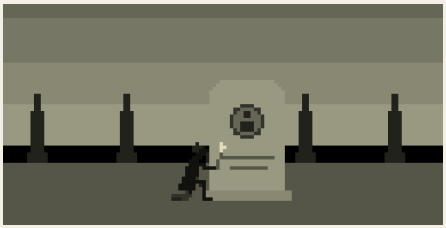
The funeral chapel



Rain on the roof



The visiting room



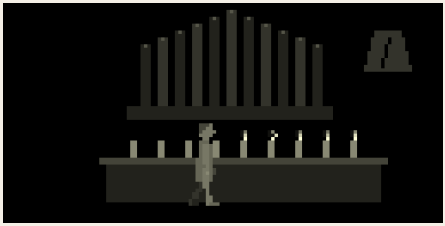
The mother you never saw



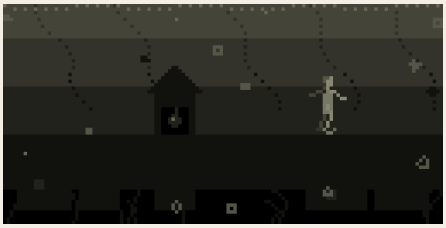
The vigil



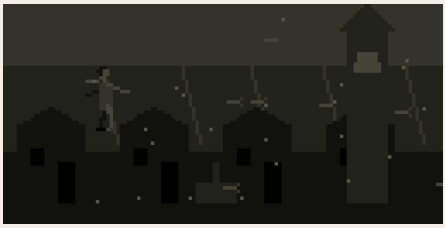
The faces you can't remember



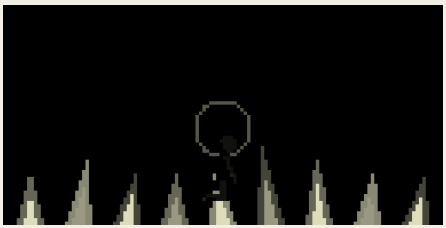
Renouncing



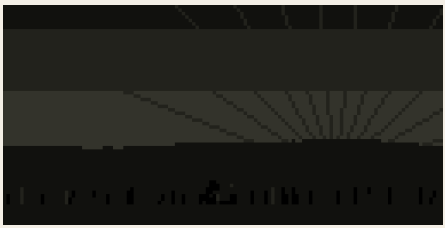
The drowned world



The drowned village



Pain



Dawn

For Massimo, for my grandparents,
and for those who remain.

un luogo moderatamente sicuro